

Information Retention & Disposal Schedule

Document Reference: CAW-GOV-RET-2026-01
System: Case Ace v2.0 Client Consultation Recording & Note Drafting System
Organisation: Citizens Advice Wandsworth (CAW)
Applicable Standard: UK GDPR Article 5(1)(e) (Storage Limitation) & AQS Level 3
Status: Formally Approved Retention Policy
Classification: Official-Sensitive / Governance

1. Executive Summary & Policy Objectives

Under UK GDPR Article 5(1)(e), personal data must be kept in a form which permits identification of data subjects for no longer than is necessary for the purposes for which the personal data are processed.

This Retention & Disposal Schedule establishes strict, automated, and operational retention timeframes across every data asset processed by or interacting with Case Ace v2.0.

2. Comprehensive Data Asset Retention Schedule

3. Detailed Disposal & Erasure Protocols

1. In-Memory Volatile Destruction (destroySession())

When an advice session ends (via explicit completion, logout, 15-minute idle timeout, consent withdrawal, tab close, or unrecoverable error), the application invokes destroySession():

```
// Deterministic in-memory zeroing protocol
if (rawAudioBuffer) {
  rawAudioBuffer.fill(0); // Cryptographic buffer overwrite
}
if (redactedAudioBuffer) {
  redactedAudioBuffer.fill(0);
}
tokenMap.clear();
transcriptStore.reset();
recoveryWorker.postMessage({ type: 'TERMINATE' });
```

2. External File Import Deletion Protocol

When an adviser imports a consultation recording from an approved dictaphone or smartphone voice memo:

The file is uploaded into browser RAM (video tracks are discarded instantly).

The consultation is transcribed, redacted, drafted, and signed off into Casebook CRM.

Mandatory Action: The adviser must immediately navigate to their local file directory and permanently delete the audio recording file from their computer and external drive.

Supervisory Check: Supervisors verify the absence of local audio files during monthly 1-to-1 audits.

3. Backend Audit Log Purge Job

The backend service executes an automated purge job every 24 hours:

```
// Automated 365-day retention purge
const cutoff = new Date(Date.now() - 365 * 24 * 60 * 60 * 1000).toISOString();
auditLogStore.purgeExpired(cutoff);
```

All logs older than 365 days are irrevocably deleted from database tables.

4. Annual Review and Audit

This Retention Schedule is reviewed annually by the CAW Data Protection Officer and Head of Operations. Any modification to cloud sub-processors or storage architectures requires a formal update and board notification.